

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Staffmark Group (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark)

Neenah, Wisconsin

Statistician

June 2025 - Present

- Design and run the lab experiments (designed experiments, DOEs) that generate training data for regression models predicting consumer perception from physical bench measurements—supporting a modeling effort that cuts reliance on expensive, multi-month consumer home-use testing across five product lines
- Build and deploy six modules on K-C's internal Python/Flask analytics platform (50+ users), turning manual statistical workflows—predictive models, lab-report automation—into self-service tools, and serve as the team's sole liaison to the platform
- Run recurring mannequin leakage analyses (5–10/month, 80+ /year) using ANOVA, mixed models, and pairwise comparisons; and analyze multiple DOEs to help establish a youth mannequin screening method projected to save the business unit millions versus multi-month consumer home-use tests
- As project statistician, design and analyze measurement-system and test-method validation studies—Gauge R&R, variable and attribute (Kappa) validations, equipment equivalency, and method transfers—owning study design, sample sizing, and acceptance criteria across multiple product lines

STAT107 Data Science Discovery

Champaign, Illinois

Undergraduate Course Assistant

August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; created, edited, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences

Champaign, Illinois

AI/ML Intern Team Leader

January 2024 - December 2024

- Led a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

PROJECTS / AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 CIC Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)

September 2024

- Analyzed socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico using geospatial and statistical analysis, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss

SKILLS

Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native)
Statistics:	Design of Experiments (DOE), Mixed Models/ANOVA, Multiple Comparisons, Gauge R&R / MSA, Method Validation (TMV), Regression & Predictive Modeling
Programming:	Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, statsmodels, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Matplotlib; R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, caret; SQL, SAS, Excel/VBA
Tools & Web:	Flask, Docker, Git, JMP, HTML/CSS, JavaScript (Chart.js, Plotly), Tableau, Office
Certificates:	Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, Illinois

Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00)

January 2023 - May 2025

- Mathematics Minor

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library

August 2025 - Present

- Help run a twice-weekly teen gaming night (2 hrs/session, 5–10 participants): organize the event, take attendance, and set up gaming consoles, puzzles, and other activities

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits